



Email Formatting issue on Apple Devices after Migration

Issue Description:

After migrating emails from Exchange Online to Google workspace, emails are rendered with html tags in MacBook mail app.

Explanation:

This is a client-side rendering issue in the native iPhone Mail app, likely caused by the app still trying to interpret the migrated emails using its old Exchange ActiveSync (EAS) or a generic IMAP protocol, which conflicts with the format of the emails now stored in Gmail Workspace.

Suggested Fix:

1. Primary Fix: Remove and Re-add Account

This procedure ensures the macOS Mail app establishes a clean connection using modern Google authentication (OAuth) and the correct IMAP protocol.

1. Remove the Account:
 - Open System Settings (or System Preferences on older macOS versions).
 - Click on Internet Accounts.
 - Select your Google/Gmail Workspace account from the list.
 - Click the Delete Account or - (minus) button and confirm.
2. Restart Mail App: Quit and re-open the Mail application.
3. Re-add the Account:
 - Go back to System Settings > Internet Accounts.
 - Click Add Account... or the + (plus) button.
 - Select Google.
 - A browser window will open to the Google sign-in page. Enter your Google Workspace email and password and complete the sign-in process, including any Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
 - Crucially, ensure you select the Mail option (and any other services like Calendar or Contacts) before the window closes.

After re-adding, the Mail app will download and index the messages using the correct protocol, which should resolve the HTML tags being displayed as raw text.

2. Alternate Fix 1: Check Mail Preferences

- Open “~/Library/Preferences/com.apple.mail.plist” in Xcode
 - Search for “PreferPlainText”
 - Set it to “NO”
 - Close Mail app and relaunch it.
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3. Alternate Fix 2: Check Mail View Settings

It is also possible that a setting in the Mail app itself is causing it to prefer the plain text part of the email.

1. Open the Mail application.
 2. In the menu bar, go to View.
 3. Check that Message > Plain Text Alternative is not selected (it should be grayed out or set to Default View). If it is currently selected, click it to switch back to the rich/HTML view.
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4. Recommended Alternative App

If the issue persists specifically for the older, migrated emails, it points to a deeper incompatibility or a flaw in how the native macOS Mail app indexed the Exchange-formatted messages.

The most reliable way to view all your Gmail Workspace emails (old and new) without rendering problems is to use a client built by Google or one optimized for Gmail's architecture:

- **Gmail Web Interface:** Access your mail directly through a web browser at mail.google.com. This is the definitive view for your messages.
- **A Third-Party Client:** Consider using a third-party macOS mail client, such as Outlook for Mac or Mimestream (which is a native app specifically built for Gmail). These often handle the nuances of Gmail's IMAP structure better than the native macOS Mail app.

For iPhones

Issue Description:

After migrating emails from Microsoft Exchange online to Google Workspace. Emails appear with HTML tags when opened in iPhone native mail app.

Explanation:

This is a **client-side rendering issue** in the native iPhone Mail app, caused by the app still trying to interpret the migrated emails using its old **Exchange ActiveSync (EAS)** or a generic **IMAP** protocol, which conflicts with the format of the emails now stored in Gmail Workspace.

Suggested Fix:

1. Primary Fix: Reconfigure the Account

The process of removing and re-adding the account forces the iPhone Mail app to establish a fresh connection to the Gmail Workspace servers, ensuring it uses the correct IMAP/OAuth settings for modern email rendering.

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. Remove the Account:

- Go to **Settings** on your iPhone.
- Scroll down and tap **Mail** (or **Contacts** or **Calendar**).
- Tap **Accounts**.
- Select the **Gmail/Google Workspace account** that is having the HTML issue.
- Tap **Delete Account** and confirm.

2. Restart Your iPhone (Recommended): A quick restart helps clear any lingering cached settings.

3. Re-add the Account:

- Go back to **Settings > Mail > Accounts**.

- Tap **Add Account**.
- Select **Google**.
- Enter your **Google Workspace email address** and tap **Next**.
- Complete the **Google sign-in** process, including any Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA). The iPhone will use the modern **OAuth** (Open Authorization) protocol, which is more reliable.

2. Technical Explanation

When you migrate from Exchange Online to Gmail, the fundamental way your mail is structured and accessed changes.

- **Exchange Online** typically uses a protocol called **Exchange ActiveSync (EAS)** or **EWS** (Exchange Web Services).
- **Gmail/Google Workspace** primarily uses **IMAP** with **OAuth**.

If you simply update the password or server name after migration, the iPhone Mail app might fail to completely switch the underlying protocol, leading it to treat the migrated email body—which contains both a plain text and HTML version (multipart email)—as just raw text, displaying all the HTML tags like <div>, <p>, and . Re-adding the account correctly negotiates the new protocol.

3. Alternative Solution: Use the Gmail App

If the issue persists in the native Apple Mail app for the migrated emails, the most stable solution is to use the official **Gmail app**.

The Gmail app is guaranteed to render your emails correctly because it's built and maintained by Google specifically to work with the structure and formatting of emails stored in Google Workspace.